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12 To clean up the ends of the pieces of fruit use a 6mm bowl gouge with an extra long grind on it, leaving a very small tip to the gouge for detail

13 Now, taking small cuts remove any waste timber where the centres once sat, remembering to rub the bevel to prevent catches. You can see from this picture I have the flute facing away from me at about the 2 o'clock position. This gives me a great view of the bevel when it's rubbing. Once the waste has been removed sand the freshly cut face and apply sanding sealer

14 When you've top and tailed your fruit, drill for the stem to be attached. Use internal step jaws, which are the same type of jaw you would normally see on an engineering chuck. I use these because they close down to 1mm so have no problem in holding my 4mm drill bit. I found this the safest way to do this step and it must be done with a sharp drill bit so you don't have to push onto the drill. Only expose enough drill bit for you to use as, at this size, too much side pressure can snap the bit. The underside of the piece of fruit needs to be drilled with a 2mm drill bit to accept a clove stem to properly finish off your apples and pears

15 Here are how the apples and pears should look when turned, sanded, sealed and drilled

16 Polish with a selection of polishing mops attached to the lathe with a pigtail. You can see there are several ways to attach your mops, but I tend to stick either with a pigtail held in the chuck or in the Morse taper of the lathe

17 The polishing process is a really pleasing one and also acts as the final sanding due to the polish itself. I use two types of polish, one for dark timbers – tripoli/tripomax – and one for light timbers – buff. These polishes are applied with a stitched polishing mop at a speed ranging between 1,000 and 1,200rpm. Once all the pieces have been polished, you can add the second part of the finish in the form of Carnauba wax applied this time with a looseleaf mop and at the same speed

18 This is now how the apples and pears should look after the final polishing process

19 Now we can draw our attention to turning the stems. I prefer to use dark timbers for this because I think they look far more authentic; in this case sonokeling (*Dalbergia latifolia*) cut into 6mm squares which I can feed up through the lathe and are gripped with the same stepped jaws we used for the drilling

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